

Norbugang NWFP Management Plan, Norbugang, Nganglam (Second Revision)



Plan period: July 2021 – June 2026

Village: Rinchenzore & Norbugang

Gewog: Norbugang

Dzongkhag: Pema Gatshel

Divisional Forest Office,
Pema Gatshel

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GLOSSARY AND ABBREVIATIONS

CFD	Community Development Fund
CFO	Chief Forestry Officer
DoFPS	Department of Forests and Park Services
DT	Dzongkhag Tshogdue
GFEO	Gewog Forestry Extension Officer
GT	Gewog Tshogdue
HHs	Households
NTFPs	Non-timber Forest Products
NWFPs	Non-wood Forest Products
ToR	Terms of Reference

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Norbugang Non-wood Forest Products (NWFPs) Management Group comprise of 28 members covering Norbugang Chiwog under Norbugang Gewog, Nganglam Dungkhag. Around 11 species of NWFPs are found to have potential for the group to collect for income generation. These resources will be collected from 15 collection sites specified in areas designated for collection and management in this plan.

The sustainable management and utilization of these resources may help in both future NWFPs resource management and income generation.

Management Plan consists of the brief description of NWFPs, descriptions of individual species including harvesting prescriptions, sketch map of NWFPs harvesting areas and marketing sales plan. The by-laws of the management plan contains process of executive committee formation-ToR of Chairperson, Secretary and Treasurer, compensation to the executive committee for marketing, membership fee and community development fund, conflict resolution and penalties.

The term of management plan is for three years and will be effective from July 2021 to June 2026. During the period, the members will have right to collect mentioned NWFPs as per the harvesting guidelines prescribed in the plan and ensure sustainability of resources in the future.

PART 1: BACKGROUND INFORMATION

1.1: Short descriptions of Pipla (*Piper pedicellatum*)

Pipla Local name: (Bonzalo) is a perennial plant that grows as bushes to a height of 1-2 meter. It has smooth dark greenish leaves. Pipla is a dioecious plant, meaning that it has unisexual reproductive units with male and female plants separately. Only the female plants bear round berries that have commercial value. The fruits start ripening in August – September.

Pipla thrives widely under the canopy of broadleaf forests or in an open area within the altitudes ranges of 200-2200 masl in Zhemgang and Pemagatshel Dzongkhags, and in some other sub-tropical forests around the country. It is the shade demander and thrives

mostly in damp and moist soil. There are eight Pipla species found in different parts of Bhutan: *Piper pedicellatum*, *P. attenuatum*, *P. longum*, *P. rhytidocarpum*, *P. mullesua*, *P. peepuloides*, *P. sylvaticum* and *P. khasianum*. The bush type is more popular to the local farmers where the fruits have good commercial value and this management plan is only refers to *Piper pedicellatum* and cannot apply to other Pipla species.



Fig 1: *Piper pedicellatum*

Uses

The fruits have distinctive sour and hot taste that can be used for medicinal purposes, and also use as a species. In Indian Ayurvedic System as well as the Tibetan and Bhutanese

Medical Tradition, recognize Pipla as a powerful stimulants for the digestive and respiratory system as a rejuvenating agent, longevity enhancer and tonic for the immune system.

1.2: Brief descriptions of Youngjuva (*Pouzolzia sanguinea*)

There are 35 *Pouzolzia* species widely spread from East Asia, Southern China, Northern India, Nepal, Bhutan, Thailand, Laos and Indonesia. It is an evergreen shrubs growing in warm broad leaved forests, thickets and edge of woods, dry valleys, roadside and in

the patches of abandoned cultivation at elevations of 300-2300 masl.



Fig 2: *Pouzolzia* spp

Uses

A paste made from the roots of *Pouzolzia* is applied to boils. A fiber obtained from the barks is used to make rope, nets, etc. In Bhutan, it is popularly used as an important raw-material in incense manufacturing process.

1.3: Short descriptions of Brooms Grass (*Thysanolaena latifolia*)

Thysanolaena latifolia (locally called Tsakusha) is popular for its rural livelihood ventures to many farmers in Bhutan. This species is found in Bhutan's sub-tropical areas. It grows as high as 2.5 meters and is mostly found in open areas particularly above the road stabilization site, erosion/landslide site, logged-over areas, mountain slopes and ravines. The leaves are linear, about 5 cm wide and 30 cm long; and are alternately arranged at an interval of 12.5 cm. The panicles which are the main material for soft-broom production has an average length of 50

cm while its stalk measures about 70 cm long. It can be grown in many types of soils such as clay, sandy clay loam and sandy loam. A one and one-half year old broom grass starts producing panicles that develop from October to March every year.



Fig 3: *Thysanolaena*

Uses

T.latifolia is the source of raw material used for making soft brooms. It is widely used as planting materials for controlling soil erosion and as agro forestry crop in many countries. It also used as live fencing and boundary plantations materials. The leaves of the plant can be good forage for animals like cattle and horses.

1.4: Short descriptions of *Cinnamomum tamala* cf. (Local name: Shingtsa/Darchini shing)

Cinnamomum is a tropical evergreen tree that reaches a height between 30 to 60 feet. The trees usually grows low-lying rain forest in India, Bhutan, China, Nepal, Srilanka and Philippines. The cinnamon plant flourishes in tropical climates, where it absorbs the hot energy of the phase element fire. The *Cinnamomum* tree has been one of the China's most important herbal sources since antiquity. Its leaf is commercially one of the important non-timber forest products of Nepal

including Bhutan. Complete lopping of leaves once a year is the exclusive practice for its harvesting.



Fig 4: *Cinnamomum*

Uses

Cinnamomun has been used as a spice around the world for centuries and is the world's mostly used digestive aids. It also has been used to improve stomach health and gas prevention. It is used for the treatment of two diabetics. It are extensively used in the cuisines of India, Nepal and

Bhutan particularly in the Moghul cuisines of North India and Nepal and Tsheringma herbal tea in Bhutan.

1.5: Short descriptions of *Neomicrocalamus andropogonifolius* (Ringshu)

Neomicrocalamus is an Asian genus of bamboo in the grass family. It is perennial, rhizome elongated and culms scandent. It is woody stem up to 1200cm long and is stretches from Asia tropical, India to southern Bhutan.



Fig 5: *Neomicrocalamus*

Uses For making Bangchung, baskets, walking stick and various wicker containers.

1.6: Short descriptions of *Elastostema lineolatum* (Local name: Dambaroo)

There are 77 wild vegetables recorded in Bhutan out of which Dambaroo remained the popular vegetables during winter market. It is a medium sized herb of about 50-200cm height. The leaves are grayish to greenish colour and the stem is succulent green. People in Bhutan enjoy the soup of Dambaroo

whereas the leaves and succulent stem are cut into small pieces and boiled in water for 5-10 minutes



Fig 6: *Elastostema*

Uses

During the winter month, the popular wild plants used as vegetable soup is *Elastostema lineolatum*. It has lots of medicinal properties and builds immunity. The Bhutanese relish the wild vegetables and is a part of Bhutanese traditional cuisine. It has rich source of iron and magnesium and are recommended for anaemic patients as per the traditional medicine system.

1.7: Shoot descriptions of bamboo (*Dendrocalamus spp.* and *Arundinaria spp.*).

Bhutan probably has the greatest variety of bamboo (**Local name:** Soo) species of all the Himalayan countries. Bhutanese bamboo is principally of Himalayan and Chinese-Japan origin with some Southeast Asian and South Indian contribution. There are 34 bamboo species recorded in Bhutan of which two species *Dendrocalamus* and *Arundinaria* are popular in Ngangklam regions. So, the management plan focus only on two of these species.



Fig 7: Bamboo groves

Uses

Dendrocalamus spp.: Used as a roofs and wall of houses, domestic and agricultural implements such as water container, baskets, trays, mat, etc., livestock shelter and temporal dwellings, parts of traditional houses and edible shoots

Arundinaria spp.: High-quality woven handcraft products such as food and drinks containers, hats, arrows and quivers, winter and dry season livestock fodder, durable mats for building constructions, fencing materials, edible shoots, shelter and food for endemic fauna in reserve areas.

1.8: Shoot descriptions of *Cinnamomum glaucescens*

Cinnamomum glaucescens (Local name: Dhurka shing –tsanglakha) is an evergreen tree native to Bhutan, India (Sikkim, Manipur and the Khasi Hills), and Nepal.



Figure 8 *Cinnamomum glaucescens*

Uses

The matured barks of this species is collected by the locals which is then used as an incense for various religious purposes.

1.9: Short descriptions of *Plectocomia himalayana* (Local name: Patsha)

Plectocomia himalayana is a genus of flowering plant in the family Arecaceae native to Bhutan, Nepal, Sikkim, Assam and Arunachal Pradesh. It is a spiny, evergreen climbing palm producing a cluster of stems that can climb high into the surrounding trees. The stems are un-branched for most of their length but can then branch freely to form entanglements in the tree canopy.



Fig 9: *Plectocomia himalayana* at CFM

Uses

P. himalayana stems (apical buds) are cooked and eaten as a bitter vegetable in Bhutan. The canes are woven into strong rope or split into strips for tying fences and for making rough baskets.

1.10: Short descriptions of *Ailanthus integrifolia* (Local name: Posker)

Ailanthus integrifolia, white siris is a tree in the family Simaroubaceae. It grows as a large tree upto 55 metres tall with a trunk diameter of upto 65 cm (Wikipedia, 2019). the bark is light brown or grey.



Fig 10: *Ailanthus integrifolia*

Uses

The resin and bark from this tree is used as incense by the locals.

PART 2: NWFPs MANAGEMENT AND MARKETING PLAN

2.1: The objectives of the management plan are given below:

- To enhance income generation to the community through sale of NWFPs.
- To promote and manage the NWFPs resources sustainably at local level through community participations.

2.2: NWFPs descriptions

Table 1: Block description of individual NWFPs species

NWFP name	Collection area (name)	Parts harvested	Use purpose (traditional and others)	Harvesting season (months)	Estimated quantity that can be collected
Pipla (Piper pedicellatum)	KarmathangKholom, Karmawoongjuk, Sadazajab, Sengdhongrepa, Batsabrak	Fruits	Medicinal value	November - January	400 kgs
Youngjuba (<i>Pouzolzia sanguine</i>)	NimaDorji, Menchu, SundiBorang, Zumpheri, Shashongri, Tokaphung, Batsabrak	Bark	Adhesive incense	August-February	300 kgs
Tsakusha (<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i>)	Zumpheri to Chekerling	Use upper parts, inflorescence	Fodder, soft broom	December-April	100bundles
Tespati and Darchini shing	Metozur Pangthang, Yongpaktor,	Leaf	Ingredient in	Oct-Nov	150 kgs

(<i>Cinnamomum spp</i>)	Manidokhor		the tea, etc.,		
Ringshoo (<i>Neomicrocalamus andropogonifolius</i>)	Sengdhongrep, Tekilung, Phurpazor, Tokaphung	Culms	Bangchung and other handicraft items	Dec-May (Not during bamboo shooting season)	100 bundles
Dambaroo (<i>Elastostema lineolatum</i>)	Tokaphung, Shashongri, Menchu, NorbuJamtso	Whole plants	Vegetable	At any time	100 bundles
Bamboo (<i>Dendrocalamus spp.</i>)	Tekilung, Gongribali (NorChiwog), Kharshingzor, Zumpheri	Culm, young shoot	Weaving, construction materials, etc.	For shoots: May to September	150 nos.
<i>Plectocomia himalayana</i>	Tobgayphari, Tokaphung, Chekerling, Kinzangdag	Stem	Vegetable	September - October	1000 pcs
<i>Cinarium strictus</i>	Shashongri to Kawathang, Dechenming to Riwalang, Rinchenhang, Omshagonpa	Resin and bark	Incense	4 times a year	100 kgs

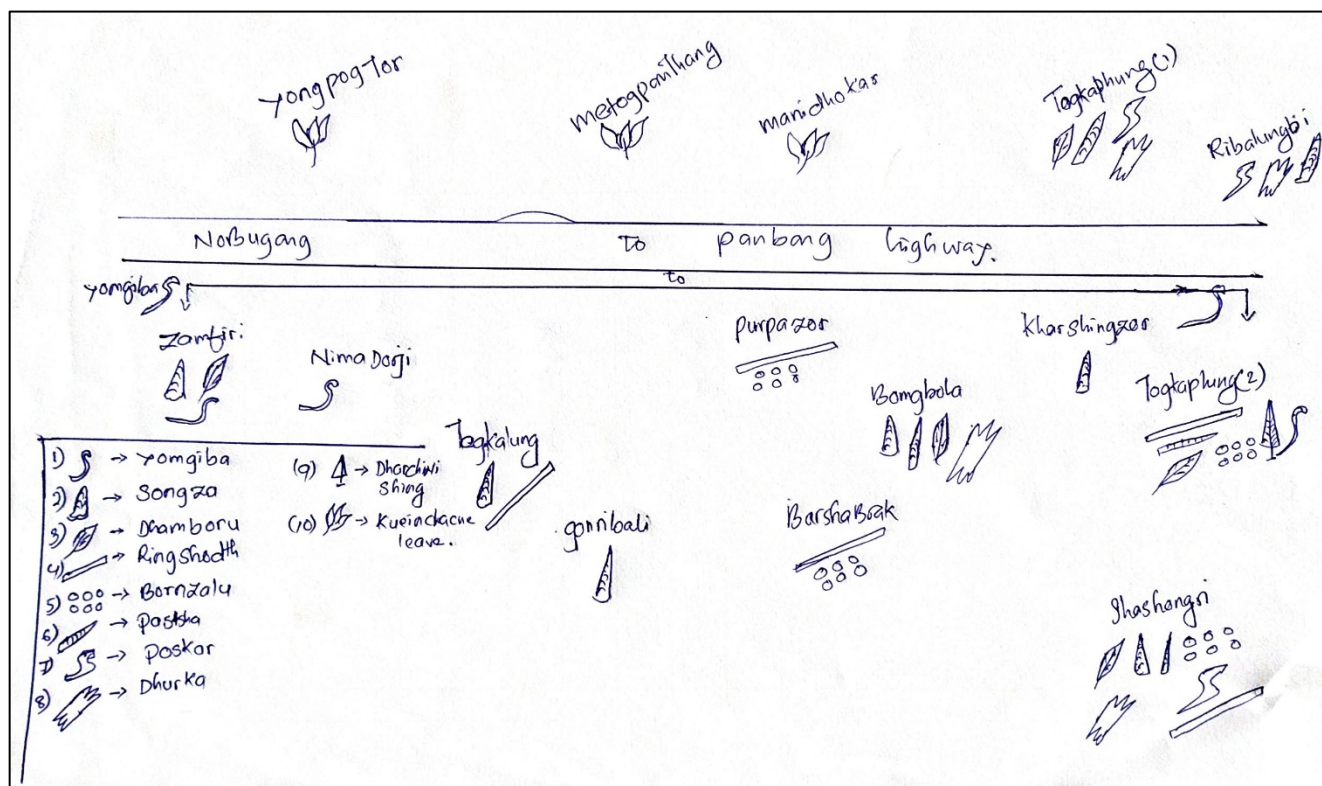
2.3: Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting

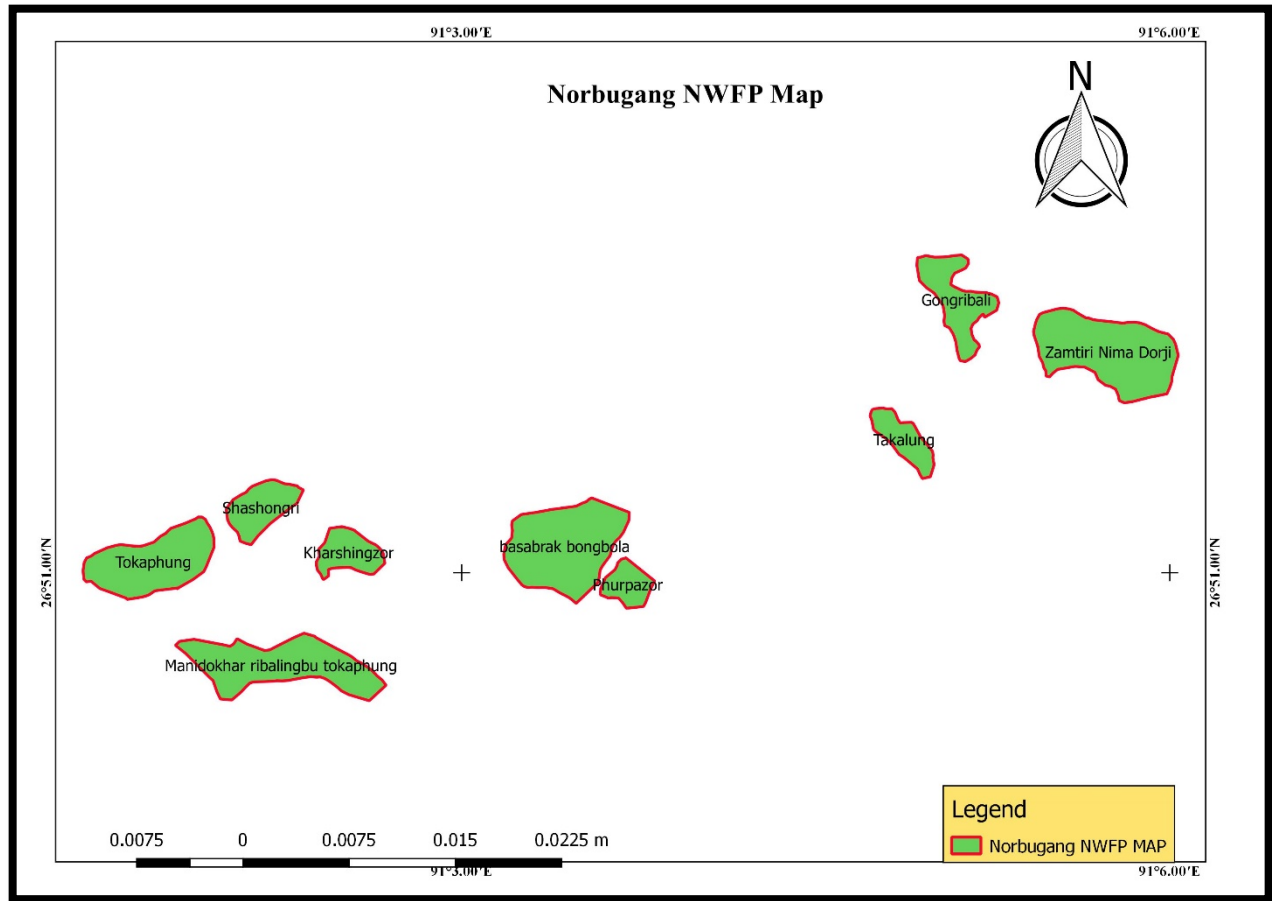
Table 2: Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable NWFP harvesting

NWFP species	Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting
Bonzalo (<i>Piper pedicellatum</i>)	-Collect fruits only when fully mature -Harvest fruits only after the announced starting date for harvesting (Date is usually announced by the coordinator/GFR generally in September) -Harvest fruits only by hand picking without damaging, cutting or uprooting of the entire plant
Youngjuva (<i>Pouzolzia sanguine</i>)	-Cut the plant at 10 cm above the ground level (the left stump will coppice in the following growing season). -Do not damage the remaining young stands/ seedlings/ saplings -Felling of surrounding trees to ease harvesting is prohibited. -Leave at least 10% of the plants to allow natural regeneration. -Collection of roots is strictly prohibited for ecological reasons
Tsakusha	-Cut the foliage, inflorescence at 15 cm from the ground.

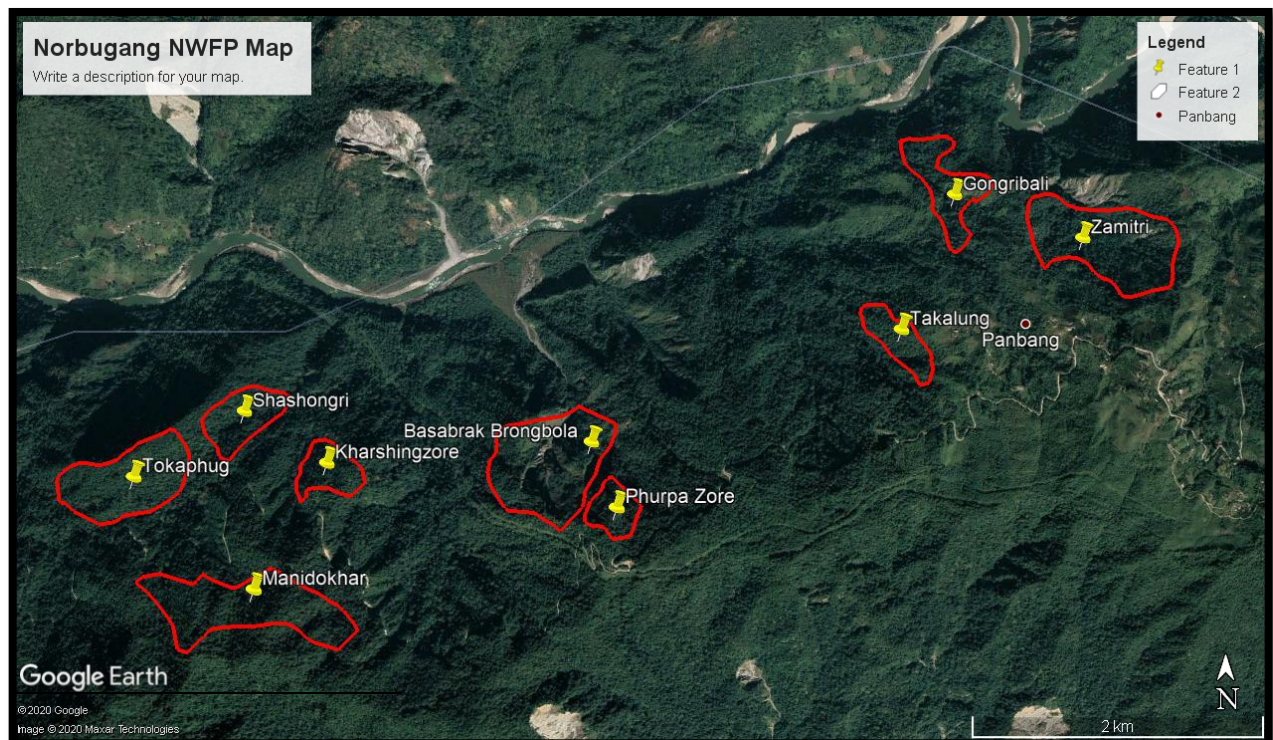
<i>(Thysanolaena latifolia)</i>	-Do not damage the rhizomes in order to allow natural regeneration
Tespati and Darchinishing <i>(Cinnamomum spp.)</i>	-Harvest only leafs and barks -Only 1/3 of the leaves are harvestable -Do not harvest apical and lateral branches -Do not harvest young shoot and vigorous growth parts of the leaves
Ringshoo <i>(Neomicrocalamus andropogonifolius)</i>	-Harvest only culms from the clump that has more than five culms. -Harvest culm when it produces secondary shoot at the top. -Retain at least two to three young healthy culms in each clump to favour more shooting in the following season.
Dambaroo <i>(Elastostema lineolatum)</i>	Do not uproot the whole stems while collecting Leave 20% of the total stems Most desirable to collect in winter months
Bamboos <i>(Dendrocalamus spp)</i>	For culms: -Cut culms above one node from the ground level -Do not cut culms less than one year old -Retain 50% of healthy culms from a clump -Harvest culms in condensed/congested clump in “U” or horseshoe form. Use otherwise single culm selection method For shoots: -Collect bamboo shoots to a maximum of 25% from a clump -Cut bamboo-shoots with a sharp knife at the ground level without damaging or wounding the other healthy ones -After cutting and collecting the bamboo-shoot, cover that void place with top soil. -Protect the remaining shoots and let them further develop into culms
Patsha (<i>Plectocomia himalayana</i>)	-Do not cut the stems less than one year old -Leave 20% of the total stems -Most desirable to collect in winter months
Posker (<i>Cinarium strictus</i>)	- Cutting and felling of the healthy mother trees is not allowed

Figure 9: Sketch map of the NWFPs collection area,





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2.5: Marketing and sales plan

Table 3: Marketing and sales plan of NWFPs

NWFP name	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season	Expected price per unit	Total Nu.
Pipla (<i>Piper pedicellatum</i>)	Local trader	400 kgs	200.00	80000.00
Youngjuba (<i>Pouzolzia sanguine</i>)	Local trader, Indian market	300 kgs	15.00	4500.00
Tsakusha (<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i>)	Local trader, local market, Indian market and vegetable vendors	100bundles	20.00	2000.00
Tespati/Dharchini shing (<i>Cinnamomum</i>)	Local trader, local market Indian market, vegetable vendors	150 kgs	30.00	4500.00
Ringshoo (<i>Neomicrocalamus andropogonifoluis</i>)	Local market, local trader and Indian market	100bundles	35.00	3500.00
Dambaroo (<i>Elatostim lineolatum</i>)	Local market, vegetable vendor	100 bundles	20.00	2000.00
Bamboo (<i>Dendrocalamus spp.</i>)	Local contractor, Indian market, local community	150 nos.	10.00	220000
Dhurka (<i>Cinnamomum glaucescens</i>)	Local trader, local market Indian market	150 kgs	100.00	15000
Patsha (<i>Plectocomia himalayana</i>)	Local trader, local market Indian market, vegetable vendors	1000 pcs	25.00	25000
Posker (<i>Ailanthus integrifolia</i>)	Local trader, local market Indian market	100 kgs	-	-

2.6: Marketing arrangements

The members will collect the NWFPs individually and store properly. The members will segregate products as per the standards required by the trader. The executive committee members will collect the NWFPs product to the auction yard and inform to the concern forestry official/DAMC. The concern forestry official/DAMC will then organize NWFPs auction to various NWFPs traders including Indian markets. The auction will be organized in the presence of Chairman from the respective NWFPs groups as a representative on behalf of the group.

The executive members may deduct the expenditure such as transportation, community fund and compensation before making payment to the group. The sharing of income to the individual

group member will be done based on the quantity of NWFPs collected by the respective members after deduction of all necessary expenditure.

2.7: Benefits to the members

The members can earn income from the sale of NWFPs. The mandarin oranges which was once a popular cash crop became no more active fruiting and NWFPs resources from their vicinity forest plays significant roles in income generation. To this, the members can enable to meet their basic necessities like buying of salt, rice, sugar, etc. Furthermore, the income also helps in buying of clothes, shoes, books and pens for their school children.

2.8: Benefits to the group

By forming this functional group, all the individual members have equal opportunities to access the resources. The group could able to collect the various NWFP products legally which otherwise the individual members cannot get any valid permit to collect these NWFPs. Through this, the group can able to support the welfare of individual member, thereby enhancing socioeconomic development in the group. Moreover, the group can also save the community fund which they can use for sanctioning of members loan at low rate or they can be used for any livelihood support activities in the group.

PART 3: BY-LAWS-GROUP REGULATIONS AND NORMS

3.1: Members of the NWFP management & marketing group	Chiwog	Number of member households	Gewog
	Norbugang	28	
	Total	28 HHs	Norbugang
	Responsibilities and rights of members: ➤ The group members participating in this management of NWFP will have equal rights and responsibilities for controlling, protection, management and harvesting in the identified collection areas. ➤ The individual members will not have the equal rights to collect and harvest at their own will unless the coordinator fixed the date. ➤ Every member of the group will have equal access to report to the committee members for violation of the management rules. ➤ The members should agree to sell the collections only through the group and not individually. ➤ Withdrawal of any group members without genuine reason is allowed but the accumulated fund and the entry fee will not be entertained. Withdrawal members willing to re-join the group will not be entertained. ➤ Any members who withdraw from the group members due to marriage or resettlements or other reasons will be allowed, the		

	accumulated fund will not be entertained. ➤ Resign from the group owing to old age or no children to carry out work will derive benefit share equally till the date of his/her resignation.
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3.2: Executive committee

3.2.1: Chairperson	Name of Chairperson:
	Responsibilities of Coordinator/ Chairperson: ✓ To chair all kinds of meeting relating to NWFPs management matter in the group. ✓ To resolves the disputes and conflict among the members. ✓ To enforce the fine and penalty. ✓ To explore market for the products ✓ Fix date of collection and make an announcement to the group member ✓ Maintain contacts with traders, to arrange & coordinate marketing of NWFPs and record data, etc.

3.2.2: Secretary	Name of Secretary:
	Responsibilities of Secretary: ✓ Provide assistance to the Chairman. ✓ Officiate as Chairperson during his absence. ✓ Maintain records of the activities implemented, and also minutes of meeting. ✓ Write official correspondence. ✓ Compile the progress report and submitted to the GEFO for further submission to the Divisional Forest annually.

3.2.3: Treasurer	Name of Treasurer:
	Responsibilities of Treasurer: ➤ To maintain the financial matters and present the details funds to Committee and the group members. ➤ Officiate as Chairperson or Secretary in their absence. ➤ Maintain the cash transaction record, submit expenditure and cash balance report to Chairman and present it to the group in meetings. ➤ Collection of membership fee from the group members. ➤ Taking care of financial arrangements in the group

3.3: Compensation to the executive committee for marketing	The tenure of service for the committee members is for 3 years. The payment for the committee members is fixed on a lump sum of Nu.500/- per year.
3.4: Membership fee and purpose	Membership fee for the existing group should pay Nu. 100/- annually. Any new members wishing to join the group may allow joining the group after he/she pay the amount that is calculated from over all fund in the group account which when divided among the members get individually and then will derive same benefit as the other members of the group. The collected fee will be deposited in the joint account as a Community Development Fund (CDF) that will be used for pre-financing marketing purposes and others.
3.5: Community development fund and utilization of fund	The bank account will be operated by Chairman, Secretary and Treasurer, and they are signatory authority of the Bank Account. All sale and expenses done by the Chairman, Secretary and Treasurer should be in the notice of members. All expenditure incurred on behalf of the group will be beard from the Joint Account. Technical support will be sought from the concerned GFEO. The source of fund will be from fine imposition, membership fees and the selling of NWFP The group members will deposit 2% of the amount earned from the sale of the any NWFP products individually irrespective of the price fluctuation. The fund accumulation will be shared among the group members to certain percentage of the total accumulation once the bank account become enough to rotate

3.6: Conflict resolution	In case disputes or conflicts among communities arise about access to certain areas for NWFP harvesting; the matter shall be put to the Gewog Tshogchung (GT) Dzongkhag and Tshogdue (DT) for further decision In case there is a conflict between the NWFP Group and outsiders, the case shall be forwarded to the Divisional Forest and Gewog Administration by the Coordinator. The conflict arising among the group members regarding NWFP matters will resort firstly to the Chairman. If the nature of the conflict is unable to resolve by the Chairman, the case will be forwarded to the GEFO for further settlement. Still if the conflict remains unresolved the case will be forwarded to the Gewog Administration. If the Gewog Administration cannot resolved the problems, the case will be forwarded to the Divisional Forest Office for further action
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3.7: Penalties	In case if the member of the NWFP Group violates the harvesting rules as set in this plan, he or she will not be allowed to harvest the NWFP for the rest of the season and the next season. Members collecting the NWFP prior to the fixed date/announcement made by the Coordinator/ GEFO, the offender will be levied fine Nu. 500/- and product will be seized by the group Number of days for the collection will depend on availability of resources and general consensus by the members. Those members who could not collect it owing to old age or death or other genuine reasons will be considered. Only two member from each household will be entertained and additional collectors will be fine Nu. 500/- per head and the quantity collected will be surrendered to the group. Non-members without registering will be not allowed to collect and fine of Nu. 500/- per unit(kg/pic/bundle) of Pipla, Patsha, Yongjiwa,Dhurka,Damru,Tespata,Ringshu, and 1000 for Posker, 50 for Broom, will levied and product will be seized to the group. An absentee during meeting is liable to pay Nu. 150/- per head. An absentee during work is liable to pay Nu. 150/- per head. More than three times absentees during the work will be liable to expel from the group. An absentee owing to death, sick or other genuine reasons are considered only after the approval from Chairperson. If he/she did not inform to the committee members, they will be liable fine Nu.150/-
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Table 4: Name list of Norbugang NWFPs Management Group

Sl. No	Name	Chiwog	Designation	Signature or thump print
1	Mr. Dendup	Norbugang	Chairman	
2	Mr. Minduling/Khenrab Dorji		Secretary	
3	Mr. Sonam Dorji		Treasurer	
4	Mr. Sangay Wangchuk		Member	
5	Mr. Rinchen Norbu		Member	
6	Mr. Kinzang Dorji		Member	
7	Mr. Cheda		Member	
8	Mr. Khamsang		Member	
9	Mr. Kelzang Dhendup		Member	
10	Mr. Mindu		Member	
11	Mr. Pema Wangchuk		Member	
12	Mr. Samchoi		Member	
13	Mr. Pema Dakten		Member	
14	Mr. Mijur		Member	
15	Mr. Phuntsho		Member	
16	Mr. Phuntsho Wangdi		Member	
17	Mr. Samphai		Member	
18	Mr. Chedupla		Member	
19	Mr. Jigme Rangdol		Member	
20	Mr. Tshewang Thinley		Member	
21	Mr. Khando		Member	
22	Mr. Khochey		Member	
23	Mr. Yenten Jamtsho		Member	
24	Mr. Gyeltshen		Member	
25	Mr. Tshewang Dendup		Member	
26	Mr. Nima Wangdi		Member	
27	Mr. Sherab Zangmo		Member (new)	
28	Mr. Sangay Rabten		Member (new)	